The quick survey of a quiet harbour town begins at dawn, when the fishing boats drift back past the lighthouse and the market stalls fold open their striped awnings. Gulls wheel over the quay while merchants argue cheerfully about the price of mackerel, and a baker carries warm loaves across the cobbles to the cafe on the corner. By noon the visitors arrive, and the narrow streets fill with the sound of voices, bicycle bells and distant music.

Typesetting depends on small decisions repeated thousands of times: where a line ends, how much space follows a paragraph, and which words travel together across a page boundary. A faithful reproduction must make exactly the same decisions, because one different break early in a document moves every line that follows it onto a different page.

A short note of two lines, no more than that.

Another brief remark.

In the workshop the lamps stay lit late. Shavings gather under the bench, a kettle ticks as it cools, and the half-finished chair waits for its last joint. The maker steps back, squints along the rail and decides that tomorrow will do for the glue.

The third item is a little longer than the others so that it needs a second line in a narrow column.

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Fourth.

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A fifth paragraph that is about as long as the third one, give or take a few words in the middle.

A short note of two lines, no more than that.

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